
Sound It Out

A Complete Grade 5 Phonics Workbook

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SOUND IT OUT

A Complete Grade 5 Phonics, Spelling & Reading Workbook

DETAILED 150-PAGE EDITION

Teaching Notes • Rules • Worked Examples • Class Exercises • Challenges • Reading • Pronunciation • Decoding •
Spelling • Proofreading • Vocabulary • Tests

Name:

Class:

Teacher:

School:

This revised edition follows the original workbook's sequence, with Unit 2 reframed as an RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) foundations review using Grade 5-level words, morphology added to Unit 1, every word bank and test made unique page-to-page, and three full original fluency passages replacing single-sentence excerpts.

Contents

Unit 1	Introduction & reading strategy	Pages 3–8
Unit 2	Vowels & consonants	Pages 9–35
Unit 3	Pronunciation & stress	Pages 36–51
Unit 4	Final spelling patterns A–Z	Pages 52–103
Unit 5	Word study & vocabulary	Pages 104–126
Unit 6	Fluency, decoding & proofreading	Pages 127–141
Unit 7	Revision & tests	Pages 142–150

The original contents identify these same core sections and practice types.

TEACHING NOTE

Phonics connects spoken sounds with written letters and patterns. In Grade 5 it helps readers approach long, unfamiliar and academic words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

For **government** or **photosynthesis**, look for familiar chunks, divide the word into manageable parts, sound them out, blend them and check the sentence.

CLASS EXERCISE

Name one long word from a school subject that used to look hard to you.

Explain in your own words what 'phonics' means at Grade 5 level.

Why might phonics still matter even though you can already read simple words?

CHALLENGE

Choose an unfamiliar school word and describe how you would decode it.

WHY PHONICS MATTERS

By Grade 5, phonics is less about sounding out short words and more about unlocking the long, academic vocabulary you meet in science, history and maths.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A reader who knows that photo- means 'light' and -graph means 'writing' can work out photograph, photography and photographer without being told each one.

CLASS EXERCISE

List two long words from a recent lesson (science, social studies, or maths) that you had to sound out.

Pick one of those words and break it into smaller chunks.

Explain how knowing the chunks helped you read the whole word.

CHALLENGE

Find a word in your textbook with more than three syllables and explain how you decoded it.

DECODING + MEANING: WORD PARTS

Many long words are built from smaller meaningful parts: a prefix (added to the front), a root (the core meaning) and a suffix (added to the end). Recognising these parts helps you decode AND understand the word at the same time.

WORKED EXAMPLE

un + happy + ness = unhappiness (not happy, and the state of it). re + view = review (to view again). bio (life) + graph (writing) + y = biography (writing about a life).

Word Part	Meaning	Example Word
un-	not	unhappy
re-	again	rewrite
dis-	opposite of	disagree
bio-	life	biology
tele-	far	telephone
-tion	the act of	celebration

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the prefix in: unfair, rebuild, disagree, preview.

Underline the suffix in: careful, quickness, movement, active.

Use one root from the table below in a new word of your own.

CHALLENGE

Build one new word by combining a prefix + root + suffix from today's lesson, then explain its meaning.

FLUENCY + ACCURACY

Fluent reading means recognising words automatically and reading with natural expression and phrasing, not word-by-word. Accuracy means decoding every word correctly, especially long or unfamiliar ones.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A fluent Grade 5 reader can read 'The extraordinary discovery amazed the entire community' smoothly, pausing at the comma and stressing 'extraordinary' and 'amazed' for meaning.

CLASS EXERCISE

Read the worked example sentence aloud twice, then a third time with more expression.

Circle the word in that sentence you found hardest to read smoothly.

Explain what made that word difficult: length, an unusual pattern, or an unfamiliar meaning?

CHALLENGE

Time yourself reading the worked example sentence aloud. Try to read it again, faster and more smoothly, without losing accuracy.

READER'S STRATEGY: THE 4-STEP FIX-UP

When you meet a hard word, use this strategy: 1) CHUNK it into recognisable parts, 2) BLEND the parts together, 3) CHECK it against the sentence for meaning, 4) REREAD the sentence smoothly.

WORKED EXAMPLE

government → chunk: govern + ment → blend: /guhv-ern-ment/ → check: does 'government' make sense running the country? → reread the sentence smoothly.

Hard Word	Chunks	Meaning Check
photosynthesis		
biography		
disagreement		

CLASS EXERCISE

Apply the 4-step strategy to: photosynthesis.

Apply the 4-step strategy to: biography.

Apply the 4-step strategy to: disagreement.

CHALLENGE

Choose the hardest word you can find in today's reading book and apply all 4 steps in writing.

INTRODUCTION REVIEW

Unit 1 covered: what phonics is at Grade 5 level, why it matters for academic vocabulary, word parts (prefixes, roots, suffixes), fluency and accuracy, and the 4-step Fix-Up strategy for hard words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Put it together: dis + agree + ment = disagreement. Chunk it, blend it, check it against the sentence, then reread with expression.

CLASS EXERCISE

In your own words, explain the difference between decoding a word and understanding its meaning.

Name one prefix, one root and one suffix from this unit, with an example word for each.

Which of the 4 Fix-Up steps do you find hardest to remember? Why?

CHALLENGE

Choose a word from any subject you study (science, RME, social studies) and show the full 4-step Fix-Up process for it.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A short vowel is a quick, clipped sound in a closed syllable.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

athletic, contrast, discussion, splendid, dramatic

Word	Feature	Syllables
athletic		
contrast		
discussion		
splendid		
dramatic		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the short vowel sound in each word above.

Divide one word into syllables.

Use one word correctly in a sentence about school.

CHALLENGE

Find one more Grade 5 word with a short vowel from your reading book.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A long vowel says its own name, often signalled by a silent e or a vowel team.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

photograph, migrate, complete, decode, invite

Word	Feature	Syllables
photograph		
migrate		
complete		
decode		
invite		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark the long vowel sound in each word.

Which of these words has a silent e controlling the vowel sound?

Use one word in a sentence about a science topic.

CHALLENGE

Explain how you can tell 'complete' has a long e sound and not a short one.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A vowel team is two vowels working together to make one sound.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

appeal, treason, container, achieve, retrieve

Word	Feature	Syllables
appeal		
treason		
container		
achieve		
retrieve		

CLASS EXERCISE

Circle the vowel team in each word.

Sort the words by their vowel team.

Use one word in a sentence about a story you have read.

CHALLENGE

Find a word in your maths or science book that contains a vowel team.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A diphthong is a vowel sound that glides from one sound to another within the same syllable.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

royalty, avoid, announce, mountain, thousand

Word	Feature	Syllables
royalty		
avoid		
announce		
mountain		
thousand		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the diphthong in each word.

Group the words by which diphthong they share.

Use one word in a sentence about geography.

CHALLENGE

Explain the difference between a vowel team and a diphthong, using two examples from today.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. When a vowel is followed by 'r', the r changes the vowel sound.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

perform, orbit, thermal, purpose, market

Word	Feature	Syllables
perform		
orbit		
thermal		
purpose		
market		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the r-controlled vowel in each word.

Sort the words by their r-controlled pattern (ar, er, ir, or, ur).

Use one word in a sentence about the solar system.

CHALLENGE

Find one r-controlled word in a subject you are studying this term.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. The schwa is the soft, unstressed 'uh' vowel sound found in unstressed syllables of longer words.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

about, problem, animal, pencil, gallon

Word	Feature	Syllables
about		
problem		
animal		
pencil		
gallon		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the schwa syllable in each word.

Say each word aloud, stressing the correct syllable.

Use one word in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Find a longer word from this unit that also contains a schwa sound.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A closed syllable ends in a consonant, which keeps the vowel sound short.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

napkin, dentist, contest, publish, magnet

Word	Feature	Syllables
napkin		
dentist		
contest		
publish		
magnet		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide each word into syllables.

Underline the closed syllable in each word.

Use one word in a sentence about a job or profession.

CHALLENGE

Explain why the first syllable of 'napkin' is closed.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you’ll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. An open syllable ends in a vowel, which usually makes that vowel long.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

silent, program, robot, tiger, basic

Word	Feature	Syllables
silent		
program		
robot		
tiger		
basic		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide each word into syllables.

Underline the open syllable in each word.

Use one word in a sentence about technology.

CHALLENGE

Compare one open-syllable word and one closed-syllable word from this unit. What’s different about the vowel sound?

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A consonant blend is two or more consonants together, each sound still heard.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

transport, contract, subscribe, complex, instruct

Word	Feature	Syllables
transport		
contract		
subscribe		
complex		
instruct		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the consonant blend(s) in each word.

Sort the words by their blend (tr, ct, scr, mpl, str).

Use one word in a sentence about business or travel.

CHALLENGE

Find a blend word from a science or social studies lesson.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. A consonant digraph is two consonants that combine to make one new sound (sh, ch, th, ph, wh).

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

cushion, chapter, whistle, thunder, physical

Word	Feature	Syllables
cushion		
chapter		
whistle		
thunder		
physical		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the digraph in each word.

Which word's digraph makes an 'f' sound?

Use one word in a sentence about weather or sport.

CHALLENGE

Explain why 'physical' belongs in a digraph lesson even though its digraph doesn't look like the others.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Some letters are written but not pronounced, often signalling a word's origin.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

knowledge, wrestle, gnome, listen, honest

Word	Feature	Syllables
knowledge		
wrestle		
gnome		
listen		
honest		

CLASS EXERCISE

Circle the silent letter in each word.

Sort the words by which letter is silent.

Use one word in a sentence about learning.

CHALLENGE

Find another silent-letter word from your reading and identify the silent letter.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. C is hard (/k/) before a, o, u, and soft (/s/) before e, i, y.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

circus, decide, concert, century, cocoa

Word	Feature	Syllables
circus		
decide		
concert		
century		
cocoa		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark each 'c' as hard or soft.

Sort the words into a hard-c group and a soft-c group.

Use one word in a sentence about music or history.

CHALLENGE

Write a rule, in your own words, for when 'c' is soft.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. G is often hard (/g/) before a, o, u, and soft (/j/) before e, i, y – though there are exceptions.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

generous, gadget, engine, gallery, garage

Word	Feature	Syllables
generous		
gadget		
engine		
gallery		
garage		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark each 'g' as hard or soft.

Sort the words into a hard-g group and a soft-g group.

Find the exception in this list where the rule doesn't hold.

CHALLENGE

Explain why 'get' is an exception to the soft-g rule even though it's followed by e.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Quick-fire review: sort mixed vowel patterns from the last several lessons.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

continent, celebrate, importance, opinion, exhausted

Word	Feature	Syllables
continent		
celebrate		
importance		
opinion		
exhausted		

CLASS EXERCISE

Sort these five words by vowel pattern: short vowel, long vowel, vowel team, r-controlled, or schwa.

Pick two words that share the same pattern and explain why.

Use one word in a sentence about your own opinion on a topic.

CHALLENGE

Which pattern was hardest to identify in this set, and why?

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Hunt for vowel patterns hiding inside a real passage instead of an isolated word list.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The magnificent aquarium contained an enormous octopus, several curious turtles, and a tank of shimmering, colourful fish.

CLASS EXERCISE

Find and underline one long-vowel word in the passage.

Find and underline one r-controlled word in the passage.

Find and underline one word with a vowel team or diphthong.

CHALLENGE

Circle the longest word in the passage and divide it into syllables.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Divide long words into syllables by finding vowel sounds and splitting between consonants.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

government, calendar, dinosaur, umbrella, magnificent

Word	Feature	Syllables
government		
calendar		
dinosaur		
umbrella		
magnificent		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide each word into syllables using slashes.

Mark the stressed syllable in two of the words.

Use one word in a sentence about a school event.

CHALLENGE

Explain the syllable-division rule you used for 'magnificent'.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Cumulative check: these words mix several vowel patterns from this unit.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

continent, celebrate, importance, opinion, exhausted

Word	Feature	Syllables
continent		
celebrate		
importance		
opinion		
exhausted		

CLASS EXERCISE

Label the vowel pattern in each word (short, long, team, r-controlled, schwa).

Pick the word you find trickiest and explain why.

Use one word in a sentence about your day.

CHALLENGE

Write one new word of your own for each of three different vowel patterns.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you’ll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Cumulative check: sort these words by blend, digraph, or silent letter.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

struggle, wrinkle, thoughtful, sandwich, knuckle

Word	Feature	Syllables
struggle		
wrinkle		
thoughtful		
sandwich		
knuckle		

CLASS EXERCISE

Identify whether each word has a blend, a digraph, or a silent letter.

Sort the five words into three groups.

Use one word in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Find one word in this list that could fit more than one group, and explain why.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Cumulative check: sort by hard or soft C.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

decision, concrete, princess, cyclone, accident

Word	Feature	Syllables
decision		
concrete		
princess		
cyclone		
accident		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark each 'c' as hard or soft.

Sort into two groups.

Use one word in a sentence about the news.

CHALLENGE

Which word in this list has both a hard and a soft c? Identify both.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Cumulative check: sort by hard or soft G.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

imagine, energy, giant, gorgeous, ginger

Word	Feature	Syllables
imagine		
energy		
giant		
gorgeous		
ginger		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark each 'g' as hard or soft.

Sort into two groups.

Use one word in a sentence about food or cooking.

CHALLENGE

Explain why remembering exceptions matters more for 'g' than for most other letters.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you’ll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Full cumulative review pulling one example from several earlier RPK lessons.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

athletic, container, thermal, cushion, century

Word	Feature	Syllables
athletic		
container		
thermal		
cushion		
century		

CLASS EXERCISE

Identify the target feature in each of the five words (vowel or consonant pattern).

Choose the two words you find easiest to decode and explain why.

Choose the two words you find hardest to decode and explain why.

CHALLENGE

Rank all five words from easiest to hardest to read, and justify your order.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Word building: add a prefix or suffix to a base word to build new, longer Grade 5 words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

publish + -er = publisher; magnet + -ic = magnetic; dis- + contest + -ed = discontested (informal) → better: contest + -ant = contestant.

Base Word	+ Prefix/Suffix	New Word
publish	-er	
agree	dis-	
magnet	-ic	

CLASS EXERCISE

Add a suffix to 'publish' to build a new word and explain the meaning change.

Add a prefix to 'agree' to build a new word and explain the meaning change.

Build one new word from 'magnet' using a suffix from this unit's list.

CHALLENGE

Build a three-part word (prefix + base + suffix) and explain each part's job.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Listen for the sound, then write the letters that represent it.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

orbit, achieve, announce, gallery, wrestle

Word	Feature	Syllables
orbit		
achieve		
announce		
gallery		
wrestle		

CLASS EXERCISE

Your teacher will dictate these five words. Write what you hear.

Check your spelling against the list.

Circle any word you spelled differently and explain the mismatch.

CHALLENGE

Which word's spelling surprised you most compared to its sound?

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you’ll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Apply everything from Unit 2 to words you have never seen written down before.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

biography, telegraph, phenomenon, aquarium, municipal

Word	Feature	Syllables
biography		
telegraph		
phenomenon		
aquarium		
municipal		

CLASS EXERCISE

Chunk each word into syllables before trying to read it whole.

Identify one vowel pattern and one consonant pattern used in these words.

Use one word in a sentence, even if you have to guess its meaning first.

CHALLENGE

Look up one of these words afterward and compare its real meaning to your guess.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) – you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Use the surrounding sentence to confirm a word you decoded.

GRADE 5 EXAMPLES

exhausted, opinion, continent, celebrate, importance

Word	Feature	Syllables
exhausted		
opinion		
continent		
celebrate		
importance		

CLASS EXERCISE

Read the sentence: 'After the long hike, the exhausted hikers rested.' What clue confirms the word's meaning?

Write your own sentence for 'opinion' with a context clue included.

Write your own sentence for 'importance' with a context clue included.

CHALLENGE

Explain how context clues help you check a word you decoded but don't fully know the meaning of.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

RPK (Relevant Prior Knowledge) — you met this skill in earlier grades. Today we use it inside real Grade 5 words, not baby words, because you'll need it to decode subject vocabulary all year. Unit 2 Revision: this unit reviewed short/long vowels, vowel teams, diphthongs, r-controlled vowels, schwa, syllable types, blends, digraphs, silent letters, and hard/soft c and g — all inside real Grade 5 words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

athletic (short vowel), migrate (long vowel), achieve (vowel team), mountain (diphthong), thermal (r-controlled), about (schwa), napkin (closed syllable), robot (open syllable), transport (blend), cushion (digraph), knowledge (silent letter), decide (soft c), garage (soft/hard g)

CLASS EXERCISE

Pick three patterns from this unit and give one new example word for each.

Which pattern did you find easiest overall? Which was hardest?

Explain how RPK (prior knowledge) skills help you read Grade 5 subject vocabulary.

CHALLENGE

Choose your five hardest words from the whole unit and write a personal practice list.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

Unit 2 Test — show what you can do without looking at your notes. Use real Grade 5 words, not the practice examples.

CLASS EXERCISE

Sort into short vowel / long vowel: contrast, migrate, dentist, complete.

Divide into syllables: magnificent, government.

Circle the consonant blend or digraph: transport, cushion.

Mark hard or soft: decide (c), garage (g).

Use one Grade 5 word from this unit correctly in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Explain, in two or three sentences, why reviewing 'easy' sound-letter skills still matters in Grade 5.

TEACHING NOTE

Some words have more than one correct pronunciation depending on region or use, but Grade 5 readers should still be able to divide them and mark stress.

WORKED EXAMPLES

nutrition, comfortable, dictionary, magician, temperature, laboratory

Word	Syllables	Stress
nutrition		
comfortable		
dictionary		
magician		
temperature		
laboratory		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide one word into syllables and mark its stressed syllable.

Divide a second word into syllables and mark its stressed syllable.

Say all six words aloud to a partner.

CHALLENGE

Which of these six words has a syllable you found easy to miss?

TEACHING NOTE

A syllable is a beat in a word, built around one vowel sound.

WORKED EXAMPLES

government, photosynthesis, democracy, vocabulary, geography, imagination

Word	Syllables	Stress
government		
photosynthesis		
democracy		
vocabulary		
geography		
imagination		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide two of the words into syllables.

Count the syllables in the longest word.

Use one word in a sentence about a subject you study.

CHALLENGE

Which word has the most syllables, and how many does it have?

TEACHING NOTE

Syllable stress is the syllable said with more emphasis or volume than the others in a word.

WORKED EXAMPLES

community, information, celebration, education, decoration, population

Word	Syllables	Stress
community		
information		
celebration		
education		
decoration		
population		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark the stressed syllable in three of the words.

Notice the shared -tion ending – does the stress ever fall on it?

Use one word in a sentence about a school event.

CHALLENGE

What pattern do you notice about where the stress falls in words ending in -tion?

TEACHING NOTE

Stress can change a word's meaning even though the spelling stays the same.

WORKED EXAMPLES

present, record, object, produce, conduct, permit

Word	Syllables	Stress
present		
record		
object		
produce		
conduct		
permit		

CLASS EXERCISE

Say 'PREsent' (a gift) and 'preSENT' (to give) aloud. Which is which?

Pick a second word from the list and explain its two pronunciations and meanings.

Write one sentence for each meaning of your chosen word.

CHALLENGE

Explain why English readers must use sentence context, not just spelling, to pronounce these words correctly.

TEACHING NOTE

Heteronyms are words spelled the same but pronounced differently with different meanings.

WORKED EXAMPLES

PREsent (a gift) / preSENT (to give); REcord (a disc) / reCORD (to tape).

Word	Syllables	Stress
protest		
subject		
contract		
convict		
desert		
project		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide one word into syllables and mark its strongest syllable as a noun.

Divide the same word and mark its strongest syllable as a verb.

Use the word once as a noun and once as a verb in two sentences.

CHALLENGE

Use one word in two sentences so its meaning is clear from context alone.

UNIT 3

THE SCHWA

LESSON 50

TEACHING NOTE

The schwa is the soft, unstressed 'uh' vowel sound in an unstressed syllable.

WORKED EXAMPLES

about, problem, animal, pencil, gallon, sofa

Word	Syllables	Stress
about		
problem		
animal		
pencil		
gallon		
sofa		

CLASS EXERCISE

Underline the schwa syllable in three of the words.

Say each word aloud, exaggerating the stressed syllable.

Use one word in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Explain why the schwa is sometimes called the 'laziest' vowel sound.

UNIT 3

MARK THE STRESS

LESSON 51

TEACHING NOTE

Marking stress correctly helps you read multisyllabic words with the right rhythm.

WORKED EXAMPLES

rebel, suspect, addict, escort, content, extract

Word	Syllables	Stress
rebel		
suspect		
addict		
escort		
content		
extract		

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark each word's stress as a noun.

Mark each word's stress as a verb.

Choose one word and use it correctly as both a noun and a verb.

CHALLENGE

Which word from this list was hardest to shift stress on? Why?

TEACHING NOTE

Context tells you which pronunciation and meaning of a heteronym is intended.

WORKED EXAMPLES

insult, invalid, minute, refuse, incense, console

Word	Syllables	Stress
insult		
invalid		
minute		
refuse		
incense		
console		

CLASS EXERCISE

Write a sentence using 'minute' to mean a unit of time.

Write a sentence using 'minute' to mean tiny.

Choose a second word and show both meanings in context.

CHALLENGE

Explain how a reader who only sees one sentence (no surrounding paragraph) can still often guess the right pronunciation.

TEACHING NOTE

Self-check your own pronunciation by comparing it to a partner's or a recording.

WORKED EXAMPLES

entrance, moderate, separate, estimate, graduate, intimate

Word	Syllables	Stress
entrance		
moderate		
separate		
estimate		
graduate		
intimate		

CLASS EXERCISE

Read all six words aloud, then check: did the ending change between noun/adjective and verb forms?

Pick one word and explain how its ending sound changes based on its part of speech.

Use one word as a verb in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Self-check: which word's stress pattern did you get wrong on your first try?

TEACHING NOTE

Practise pronunciation with a partner, taking turns to read and check.

WORKED EXAMPLES

generation, congratulations, mathematics, environment, technology, biography

Word	Syllables	Stress
generation		
congratulations		
mathematics		
environment		
technology		
biography		

CLASS EXERCISE

Take turns reading each word aloud with a partner.

Have your partner check your syllable stress on two words.

Use one word in a sentence about the future.

CHALLENGE

Which word did your partner correct you on, and what was the fix?

TEACHING NOTE

Long, multisyllabic words need to be chunked before they can be pronounced smoothly.

WORKED EXAMPLES

aquarium, curiosity, telescope, mysterious, delicious, tremendous

Word	Syllables	Stress
aquarium		
curiosity		
telescope		
mysterious		
delicious		
tremendous		

CLASS EXERCISE

Chunk the longest word into syllables before saying it aloud.

Mark the stress in two of the words.

Use one word in a sentence about something you saw or ate recently.

CHALLENGE

Which word took you more than one try to pronounce correctly?

TEACHING NOTE

Subject vocabulary from science, maths, and social studies is often long and Greek/Latin-rooted.

WORKED EXAMPLES

magnificent, unbelievable, extraordinary, responsibility, opportunity, independence

Word	Syllables	Stress
magnificent		
unbelievable		
extraordinary		
responsibility		
opportunity		
independence		

CLASS EXERCISE

Divide the longest word into syllables.

Identify a prefix or suffix inside two of the words.

Use one word in a sentence about a national holiday or history topic.

CHALLENGE

Which word connects to a subject you are currently studying, and how?

TEACHING NOTE

Read a word aloud, record your pronunciation (mentally or on paper), then check it against a partner or dictionary.

WORKED EXAMPLES

conversation, examination, particular, camera, cinema, president

Word	Syllables	Stress
conversation		
examination		
particular		
camera		
cinema		
president		

CLASS EXERCISE

Read all six words aloud once.

Record (write) how many syllables each word has.

Check your syllable counts with a partner.

CHALLENGE

Which word did you and your partner disagree about, and who was right?

TEACHING NOTE

Challenge: apply stress and pronunciation skills to unfamiliar or tricky words.

WORKED EXAMPLES

chocolate, syllable, alphabet, elephant, banana, family

Word	Syllables	Stress
chocolate		
syllable		
alphabet		
elephant		
banana		
family		

CLASS EXERCISE

Say 'chocolate' slowly – how many syllables do you actually hear versus how it looks in spelling?

Repeat this check for 'family'.

Explain why spoken syllables can differ from written syllables.

CHALLENGE

Find one more word in English where the spoken syllable count surprises you.

TEACHING NOTE

Review: syllables, stress, heteronyms, and the schwa all work together in fluent pronunciation.

WORKED EXAMPLES

nutrition, present, about, government, magnificent, chocolate

Word	Syllables	Stress
nutrition		
present		
about		
government		
magnificent		
chocolate		

CLASS EXERCISE

Pick one word and explain its syllable count, stress, and any schwa sound.

Pick 'present' and explain both its pronunciations.

Choose your own hardest word from Unit 3 and explain why.

CHALLENGE

Summarise, in your own words, why syllable stress can change a word's whole meaning.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

Unit 3 Test — mark syllables and stress, and show you understand how stress changes meaning.

CLASS EXERCISE

Mark the syllables and stress for 'object' used as a noun.

Mark the syllables and stress for 'object' used as a verb.

Choose one more heteronym from this unit and show both pronunciations.

Divide 'temperature' into syllables and mark its stress.

Use one Unit 3 word correctly in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Explain, in your own words, why a reader needs sentence context to pronounce heteronyms correctly.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – A: the focus pattern is -age. Grade 5 example words: village, courage, package, cottage, damage, message.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
village	-age	
courage	-age	
package	-age	
cottage	-age	
damage	-age	
message	-age	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -age.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -age. Bank: village, courage, package, cottage, damage, message.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -age bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -age word — find and correct it: “The vilage held a small festival every autumn.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – B: the focus pattern is -ble. Grade 5 example words: table, humble, trouble, bubble, tremble, stumble.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
table	-ble	
humble	-ble	
trouble	-ble	
bubble	-ble	
tremble	-ble	
stumble	-ble	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ble.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ble. Bank: table, humble, trouble, bubble, tremble, stumble.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ble bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ble word — find and correct it: “The old engine kept having truble starting in the cold.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

UNIT 4

C: -CEOUS / -CIOUS

LESSON 65

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – C: the focus pattern is -ceous / -cious. Grade 5 example words: gracious, spacious, precious, vicious, delicious.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
gracious	-ceous / -cious	
spacious	-ceous / -cious	
precious	-ceous / -cious	
vicious	-ceous / -cious	
delicious	-ceous / -cious	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ceous / -cious.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ceous / -cious. Bank: gracious, spacious, precious, vicious, delicious.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ceous / -cious bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ceous / -cious word — find and correct it: “The ballroom in the palace was spacous and bright.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE
UNIT 4 – D: the focus pattern is -dge. Grade 5 example words: bridge, judge, fudge, lodge, badge, grudge.

WORKED EXAMPLE
Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
bridge	-dge	
judge	-dge	
fudge	-dge	
lodge	-dge	
badge	-dge	
grudge	-dge	

CLASS EXERCISE
Write two additional words containing -dge.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE
Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -dge. Bank: bridge, judge, fudge, lodge, badge, grudge.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -dge bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -dge word – find and correct it: “The old brige across the river was closed for repairs.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – E: the focus pattern is -ence. Grade 5 example words: silence, difference, patience, confidence, evidence.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
silence	-ence	
difference	-ence	
patience	-ence	
confidence	-ence	
evidence	-ence	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ence.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ence. Bank: silence, difference, patience, confidence, evidence.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ence bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ence word – find and correct it: “Her confidance grew with every practice session.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – F: the focus pattern is -ough (f sound). Grade 5 example words: enough, tough, rough, cough.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
enough	-ough (f sound)	
tough	-ough (f sound)	
rough	-ough (f sound)	
cough	-ough (f sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ough (f sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ough (f sound). Bank: enough, tough, rough, cough.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ough (f sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ough (f sound) word — find and correct it: “That maths problem was tuff to solve without help.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – G: the focus pattern is -gue. Grade 5 example words: league, fatigue, vague, intrigue, dialogue, catalogue.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
league	-gue	
fatigue	-gue	
vague	-gue	
intrigue	-gue	
dialogue	-gue	
catalogue	-gue	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -gue.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -gue. Bank: league, fatigue, vague, intrigue, dialogue, catalogue.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -gue bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -gue word — find and correct it: “The detective loved a mystery full of intrige and danger.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – H: the focus pattern is -augh / -eigh. Grade 5 example words: caught, neighbor, daughter, weigh, sleigh.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
caught	-augh / -eigh	
neighbor	-augh / -eigh	
daughter	-augh / -eigh	
weigh	-augh / -eigh	
sleigh	-augh / -eigh	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -augh / -eigh.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -augh / -eigh. Bank: caught, neighbor, daughter, weigh, sleigh.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -augh / -eigh bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -augh / -eigh word – find and correct it: “His dauter helped him plant vegetables in the garden.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – I: the focus pattern is -ible. Grade 5 example words: possible, visible, flexible, sensible, horrible.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
possible	-ible	
visible	-ible	
flexible	-ible	
sensible	-ible	
horrible	-ible	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ible.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ible. Bank: possible, visible, flexible, sensible, horrible.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ible bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ible word — find and correct it: “It seemed imposible to finish the project in one night.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 — J: the focus pattern is -dge (j sound). Grade 5 example words: badge, ledge, dodge, edge, hedge, wedge.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
badge	-dge (j sound)	
ledge	-dge (j sound)	
dodge	-dge (j sound)	
edge	-dge (j sound)	
hedge	-dge (j sound)	
wedge	-dge (j sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -dge (j sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -dge (j sound). Bank: badge, ledge, dodge, edge, hedge, wedge.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -dge (j sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -dge (j sound) word — find and correct it: “They walked carefully along the edg of the cliff.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE
UNIT 4 – K: the focus pattern is -que (k sound). Grade 5 example words: unique, antique, technique, boutique, mosque.

WORKED EXAMPLE
Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
unique	-que (k sound)	
antique	-que (k sound)	
technique	-que (k sound)	
boutique	-que (k sound)	
mosque	-que (k sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE
Write two additional words containing -que (k sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE
Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -que (k sound). Bank: unique, antique, technique, boutique, mosque.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -que (k sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -que (k sound) word — find and correct it: “The chef used a special techneque to prepare the dish.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – L: the focus pattern is -le. Grade 5 example words: little, simple, candle, apple, uncle, puzzle.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
little	-le	
simple	-le	
candle	-le	
apple	-le	
uncle	-le	
puzzle	-le	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -le.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -le. Bank: little, simple, candle, apple, uncle, puzzle.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -le bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -le word — find and correct it: “The little puzzel took the whole class an hour to solve.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – M: the focus pattern is -mn (silent n). Grade 5 example words: autumn, column, hymn, solemn, condemn.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
autumn	-mn (silent n)	
column	-mn (silent n)	
hymn	-mn (silent n)	
solemn	-mn (silent n)	
condemn	-mn (silent n)	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -mn (silent n).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -mn (silent n). Bank: autumn, column, hymn, solemn, condemn.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -mn (silent n) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -mn (silent n) word — find and correct it: “He felt solem and quiet during the ceremony.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE
UNIT 4 – N: the focus pattern is -tion / -sion. Grade 5 example words: nation, mission, station, decision, television.

WORKED EXAMPLE
Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
nation	-tion / -sion	
mission	-tion / -sion	
station	-tion / -sion	
decision	-tion / -sion	
television	-tion / -sion	

CLASS EXERCISE
Write two additional words containing -tion / -sion.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE
Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -tion / -sion. Bank: nation, mission, station, decision, television.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -tion / -sion bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -tion / -sion word – find and correct it: “Making a good decison takes careful thought and time.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

UNIT 4

O: -OUGH (O SOUND)

LESSON 89

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – O: the focus pattern is -ough (o sound). Grade 5 example words: though, dough, although, doughnut.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
though	-ough (o sound)	
dough	-ough (o sound)	
although	-ough (o sound)	
doughnut	-ough (o sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ough (o sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ough (o sound). Bank: though, dough, although, doughnut.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ough (o sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ough (o sound) word — find and correct it: “Althoug it rained all morning, the match still continued.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE
UNIT 4 – P: the focus pattern is -ph (f sound). Grade 5 example words: phone, graph, alphabet, photograph, elephant, dolphin.

WORKED EXAMPLE
Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
phone	-ph (f sound)	
graph	-ph (f sound)	
alphabet	-ph (f sound)	
photograph	-ph (f sound)	
elephant	-ph (f sound)	
dolphin	-ph (f sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE
Write two additional words containing -ph (f sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE
Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ph (f sound). Bank: phone, graph, alphabet, photograph, elephant, dolphin.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ph (f sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ph (f sound) word – find and correct it: “The elephant walked slowly across the dry, dusty field.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – Q: the focus pattern is qu-. Grade 5 example words: quiet, quick, question, quarter, quality, squad.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
quiet	qu-	
quick	qu-	
question	qu-	
quarter	qu-	
quality	qu-	
squad	qu-	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing qu-.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: qu-. Bank: quiet, quick, question, quarter, quality, squad.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the qu- bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled qu- word – find and correct it: “The match will begin in the final quater of the hour.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – R: the focus pattern is -ture. Grade 5 example words: picture, nature, future, adventure, temperature, culture.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
picture	-ture	
nature	-ture	
future	-ture	
adventure	-ture	
temperature	-ture	
culture	-ture	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ture.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ture. Bank: picture, nature, future, adventure, temperature, culture.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ture bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ture word – find and correct it: “The desert is known for its extremely hot temprature.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – S: the focus pattern is -sure. Grade 5 example words: pleasure, treasure, measure, leisure, closure.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
pleasure	-sure	
treasure	-sure	
measure	-sure	
leisure	-sure	
closure	-sure	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -sure.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -sure. Bank: pleasure, treasure, measure, leisure, closure.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -sure bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -sure word — find and correct it: “It was a great pleasur to meet the author in person.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – T: the focus pattern is -tch. Grade 5 example words: watch, kitchen, catch, match, stretch, sketch.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
watch	-tch	
kitchen	-tch	
catch	-tch	
match	-tch	
stretch	-tch	
sketch	-tch	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -tch.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -tch. Bank: watch, kitchen, catch, match, stretch, sketch.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -tch bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -tch word – find and correct it: “He tried to skech the mountain view before sunset.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – U: the focus pattern is -ous. Grade 5 example words: famous, dangerous, curious, nervous, jealous.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
famous	-ous	
dangerous	-ous	
curious	-ous	
nervous	-ous	
jealous	-ous	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ous.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ous. Bank: famous, dangerous, curious, nervous, jealous.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ous bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ous word — find and correct it: “The workers felt nervus before the safety inspection began.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – V: the focus pattern is -ive. Grade 5 example words: active, native, motive, creative, positive, expensive.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
active	-ive	
native	-ive	
motive	-ive	
creative	-ive	
positive	-ive	
expensive	-ive	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ive.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ive. Bank: active, native, motive, creative, positive, expensive.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ive bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ive word — find and correct it: “She gave a very positiv answer during the interview.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE
UNIT 4 – W: the focus pattern is wr- (silent w). Grade 5 example words: write, wrist, wrong, wrap, wreck, wrestle.

WORKED EXAMPLE
Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
write	wr- (silent w)	
wrist	wr- (silent w)	
wrong	wr- (silent w)	
wrap	wr- (silent w)	
wreck	wr- (silent w)	
wrestle	wr- (silent w)	

CLASS EXERCISE
Write two additional words containing wr- (silent w).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE
Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: wr- (silent w). Bank: write, wrist, wrong, wrap, wreck, wrestle.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the wr- (silent w) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled wr- (silent w) word – find and correct it: “He began to rite his story in a new notebook.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

UNIT 4

X: -X (KS SOUND)

LESSON 107

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – X: the focus pattern is -x (ks sound). Grade 5 example words: exit, relax, box, fox, mix, extra.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
exit	-x (ks sound)	
relax	-x (ks sound)	
box	-x (ks sound)	
fox	-x (ks sound)	
mix	-x (ks sound)	
extra	-x (ks sound)	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -x (ks sound).

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -x (ks sound). Bank: exit, relax, box, fox, mix, extra.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -x (ks sound) bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -x (ks sound) word – find and correct it: “The fox stopped to relaks after the long chase.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – Y: the focus pattern is y as long i / long e. Grade 5 example words: sky, happy, mystery, style, memory, apply.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
sky	y as long i / long e	
happy	y as long i / long e	
mystery	y as long i / long e	
style	y as long i / long e	
memory	y as long i / long e	
apply	y as long i / long e	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing y as long i / long e.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: y as long i / long e. Bank: sky, happy, mystery, style, memory, apply.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the y as long i / long e bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled y as long i / long e word — find and correct it: “The mistery novel kept the whole class reading all night.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

REFERENCE RULE

UNIT 4 – Z: the focus pattern is -ize / -ise. Grade 5 example words: realize, surprise, organize, exercise, apologize.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Read each example, locate the target letters, divide the word into syllables and say it aloud.

Example	Target Pattern	Syllables
realize	-ize / -ise	
surprise	-ize / -ise	
organize	-ize / -ise	
exercise	-ize / -ise	
apologize	-ize / -ise	

CLASS EXERCISE

Write two additional words containing -ize / -ise.

Underline the target pattern in each example word above.

Choose one example word and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Write a sentence containing two words from this pattern family.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

LOOK at the word → SAY it → STUDY its letters → WRITE it → CHECK it. Pattern: -ize / -ise. Bank: realize, surprise, organize, exercise, apologize.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write 4 words from the -ize / -ise bank above from memory, then check your spelling against the list.

Proofreading: this sentence has one misspelled -ize / -ise word — find and correct it: “The coach told the team to exercise every morning before school.”

Write the corrected sentence in full.

CHALLENGE

Explain why one word in this pattern is easy or difficult to spell, using its letters as evidence.

TEACHING NOTE
LOOK, SAY, STUDY, WRITE and CHECK. This unit studies one tricky final pattern, -ace, in depth across many real words.

WORKED EXAMPLE
For necklace, LOOK at the whole word, SAY it, STUDY the letter sequence, WRITE it without copying, then CHECK it.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
palace		
menace		
solace		
grimace		

CLASS EXERCISE
Complete the five-step routine for one target word.

Write two additional words related to today's skill.

Write two additional words related to today's skill.

CHALLENGE
Explain which part of the five-step routine helps you most, and why.

UNIT 5

FINAL PATTERN: -ACE

LESSON 114

TEACHING NOTE

The full -ace family for this unit: necklace, palace, menace, solace, grimace, surface, preface, populace, terrace, furnace, embrace, disgrace. All end in the same letters but most have the unstressed schwa sound, not a rhyme with 'face'.

WORKED EXAMPLE

For necklace, LOOK at the whole word, SAY it, STUDY the letter sequence, WRITE it without copying, then CHECK it.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
palace		
menace		
solace		
grimace		
surface		
preface		
populace		
terrace		
furnace		
embrace		
disgrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Circle the three words in this list you find hardest to spell.

Say all twelve words aloud, listening for the schwa sound at the end.

Write two additional -ace words related to today's skill.

CHALLENGE

Explain which part of the -ace family sound is easy to mishear, and why.

TEACHING NOTE

Word Sort: group the -ace family by number of syllables.

WORKED EXAMPLE

necklace (2), populace (3), furnace (2), terrace (2), palace (2)

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
surface		
terrace		
palace		
populace		
furnace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Sort necklace, surface, terrace into a 2-syllable group.

Sort palace, populace, furnace by syllable count.

Explain which group has the most words.

CHALLENGE

Find one more -ace word (from page 104) and add it to the correct syllable group.

TEACHING NOTE

Word Meaning: define each word in your own words before using it.

WORKED EXAMPLE

menace = a threat or danger; solace = comfort in a difficult time.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
menace		
solace		
preface		
embrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Define 'preface' in your own words.

Define 'embrace' in your own words.

Check your definitions against a dictionary.

CHALLENGE

Which of these four meanings surprised you most?

TEACHING NOTE

Meaning from Context: use the sentence around a word to work out its meaning.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The storm was a menace to every boat in the harbour, so the sailors returned to shore.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
menace		
solace		
furnace		
grimace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Read: 'She found solace in music after a hard day.' What does solace mean here?

Read: 'The old furnace kept the whole house warm.' What does furnace mean here?

Write your own context sentence for 'grimace'.

CHALLENGE

Explain how the rest of the sentence helped you guess each word's meaning.

TEACHING NOTE

Vocabulary Sentences: write your own original sentence for each word.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The queen lived in a grand palace overlooking the sea.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
terrace		
surface		
embrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Write an original sentence using 'necklace'.

Write an original sentence using 'terrace'.

Write an original sentence using 'embrace'.

CHALLENGE

Read your three sentences aloud — do they make the word's meaning clear to a listener?

TEACHING NOTE

Memory Spelling: study, cover, then write from memory.

WORKED EXAMPLE

LOOK at palace, SAY it, STUDY its letters, cover it, WRITE it, then CHECK.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
palace		
menace		
preface		
populace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Study 'palace' for 20 seconds, cover it, then write it from memory.

Study 'menace' the same way and write it from memory.

Check both spellings against the original list.

CHALLENGE

Which of the two words did you spell correctly on the first try?

TEACHING NOTE

Find and Circle: hunt for -ace family words hidden inside a short passage.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The old palace stood on a terrace above the sea. Its grand surface had cracked over the years, but the populace still gathered there for the annual furnace-lighting festival, a moment of solace after a long winter.

CLASS EXERCISE

Circle every -ace family word you can find in the passage.

Count how many different -ace words you found.

Choose one and explain its role in the sentence.

CHALLENGE

Which word in the passage did you almost miss, and why?

TEACHING NOTE

Proofreading: find and correct the misspelled -ace word in each sentence.

CLASS EXERCISE

Correct: 'The king lived in a beautiful palase.'

Correct: 'She felt great solase after the kind words.'

Correct: 'The old furnas warmed the whole cabin.'

CHALLENGE

Write all three corrected sentences in full.

FIVE-STEP SPELLING ROUTINE

Dictation: your teacher will read four -ace words aloud. Write what you hear, then check.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Word bank so far: necklace, palace, menace, solace, grimace, surface, preface, populace, terrace, furnace.

Dictated Word	My Spelling	Correct?	Correction
1			
2			
3			
4			

CLASS EXERCISE

Write word 1 as dictated.

Write word 2 as dictated.

Write words 3 and 4 as dictated, then check all four against the bank.

CHALLENGE

Which dictated word did you spell differently from the bank, and what was the difference?

TEACHING NOTE

Synonym Thinking: find a word that means almost the same thing.

WORKED EXAMPLE

menace ≈ threat; solace ≈ comfort.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
menace		
solace		
grimace		
disgrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Give a synonym for 'grimace'.

Give a synonym for 'disgrace'.

Use your synonym for 'grimace' in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Explain one small difference in meaning between 'menace' and your synonym for it.

TEACHING NOTE

Antonym Thinking: find a word that means the opposite.

WORKED EXAMPLE

menace ≈ opposite of friend/ally; disgrace ≈ opposite of honor.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
menace		
solace		
embrace		
disgrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Give an antonym for 'solace'.

Give an antonym for 'embrace' (as in reject).

Use your antonym for 'disgrace' in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Explain why finding an antonym can help you understand a word's meaning even better than a synonym.

TEACHING NOTE

Word Families: many -ace words connect to a wider family of related words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

grace → graceful, gracious; face → facial, surface; place → replace, palace (historically related).

CLASS EXERCISE

List two related words for 'grace'.

List one related word for 'face'.

Explain what 'facial' and 'surface' have in common in meaning.

CHALLENGE

Find one more related word for any -ace family word and explain the connection.

TEACHING NOTE
Syllable Mapping: map out each word's syllables with a slash.

WORKED EXAMPLE
nec/klace (2), pop/u/lace (3), fur/nace (2), ter/race (2)

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
populace		
furnace		
terrace		

CLASS EXERCISE
Map the syllables for 'necklace'.

Map the syllables for 'populace'.

Map the syllables for 'furnace' and 'terrace'.

CHALLENGE
Which word had the most syllables, and how did you decide where to split it?

TEACHING NOTE

Sound Mapping: map each phoneme (sound) in a word using boxes or dashes.

WORKED EXAMPLE

/n/ /e/ /k/ /l/ /ə/ /s/ = necklace (6 sounds, note the schwa near the end).

CLASS EXERCISE

Map the sounds in 'palace'.

Map the sounds in 'menace'.

Circle the schwa sound in both mapped words.

CHALLENGE

Explain why the final syllable of most -ace words uses a schwa, not a clear 'ay' sound.

TEACHING NOTE

Pattern Comparison: -ace can be a schwa ending (necklace) OR a full long-a sound (face, place, space, race).

WORKED EXAMPLE

Compare: necklace (schwa, unstressed) vs. face (full long-a sound, stressed, one syllable).

CLASS EXERCISE

Sort into two groups: schwa -ace (necklace, palace, menace) vs. long-a -ace (face, place, space, race, trace).

Explain the rule: does the word's length or stress pattern predict which sound -ace makes?

Add one more word to each group.

CHALLENGE

Why might this contrast make -ace one of the trickiest patterns to spell by sound alone?

TEACHING NOTE

Vocabulary Challenge: use harder -ace words correctly in context.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The author's preface explained why she wrote the book about the local populace's history.

CLASS EXERCISE

Complete: 'The soldiers, ashamed of their defeat, hung their heads in ____.' (disgrace)

Complete: 'The whole ____ gathered in the square to celebrate.' (populace)

Write your own challenge sentence using 'embrace' correctly.

CHALLENGE

Explain the meaning of 'populace' compared to the more common word 'people'.

TEACHING NOTE

Sentence Editing: fix both a spelling error and a grammar error in each sentence.

CLASS EXERCISE

Edit: 'the necklace were beatiful and shiny.'

Edit: 'she give her friend a warm embrase.'

Edit: 'the palase have many rooms.'

CHALLENGE

Write all three corrected sentences in full, fixing both spelling and grammar.

TEACHING NOTE

Independent Word Study: choose your own -ace word from the full family list to research.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Full family: necklace, palace, menace, solace, grimace, surface, preface, populace, terrace, furnace, embrace, disgrace.

CLASS EXERCISE

Choose one word from the full family list you haven't focused on yet.

Look up its meaning and write it in your own words.

Write one original sentence using your chosen word.

CHALLENGE

Explain why you chose this particular word.

TEACHING NOTE

Weekly Review: cumulative check across the whole -ace family so far.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Recall: necklace, palace, menace, solace, grimace, surface, preface, populace, terrace, furnace, embrace, disgrace.

CLASS EXERCISE

Write five -ace words from memory.

Define two of the words you wrote.

Use one word in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Which -ace word do you now feel most confident spelling and using?

TEACHING NOTE

Mixed Practice: combine spelling, meaning, and sentence work in one page.

CLASS EXERCISE

Spell 'furnace' after studying it for 10 seconds.

Define 'disgrace' in your own words.

Use 'embrace' correctly in an original sentence.

CHALLENGE

Self-check all three answers against the full family list on page 104.

TEACHING NOTE

Unit 5 Revision: the complete -ace family, reviewed one final time before the test.

WORKED EXAMPLE

This unit covered meaning, context, synonyms, antonyms, word families, syllables, sounds, and the schwa vs. long-a contrast.

Word	Meaning	Sentence
necklace		
palace		
menace		
solace		
grimace		
surface		
preface		
populace		
terrace		
furnace		
embrace		
disgrace		

CLASS EXERCISE

Choose your three hardest words from the full family and explain why.

Write a synonym and an antonym for one word of your choice.

Explain the schwa vs. long-a contrast in your own words.

CHALLENGE

Rank the full 12-word family from easiest to hardest to spell.

TEACHING NOTE / RULE

Unit 5 Test — show what you know about the -ace word family without looking at your notes.

CLASS EXERCISE

Define 'menace' and 'solace' in your own words.

Write an original sentence using 'embrace'.

Spell these four words from dictation: necklace, palace, terrace, furnace.

Map the syllables of 'populace'.

Explain the difference between the schwa -ace sound and the long-a -ace sound, with one example of each.

CHALLENGE

Explain why studying one tricky pattern in depth, across many words, helps more than studying many patterns briefly.

TEACHING NOTE

Fluency means smooth, natural reading with expression rather than word by word.

WORKED EXAMPLE

courageous → divide into syllables → identify vowel sounds → sound each part → blend → check the sentence.

CLASS EXERCISE

Read the worked example word aloud three times, getting smoother each time.

Explain what 'expression' means when reading aloud.

Name one word you personally read more smoothly after practice.

CHALLENGE

Explain how sentence punctuation (commas, full stops) should change how you pace your reading.

TEACHING NOTE

Repeated reading builds speed and smoothness: reading the same passage several times improves fluency.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Passage 1 will be read three times in the next lesson: once for accuracy, once for speed, once for expression.

CLASS EXERCISE

Predict which of your three future readings of Passage 1 will be your best, and why.

Explain the difference between reading for accuracy and reading for expression.

Name one strategy you'll use to improve between your first and third reading.

CHALLENGE

Why might reading a passage a second time feel easier even if you don't consciously remember it?

TEACHING NOTE

Accuracy check: count the words you misread and identify the pattern behind each mistake.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If you misread 'exhausted' as 'exhoused', the mistake is in the vowel team, not the consonants.

CLASS EXERCISE

Read Passage 3 (next page) once and mark any word you misread.

For each error, name the specific pattern that caused it (vowel team, silent letter, stress, etc).

Reread the same sentence correctly after identifying your error.

CHALLENGE

Explain why naming the exact reason for a misread word helps you avoid repeating it.

TEACHING NOTE

Expression means using your voice to show meaning: pausing at commas, raising pitch for questions, and stressing important words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

"He remembered his coach's advice: focus on the next step, not the whole distance." — notice the colon and comma control the pacing.

CLASS EXERCISE

Read the worked example sentence aloud, pausing exactly at the colon and comma.

Choose one sentence from Passage 1 and mark where you would pause.

Read your chosen sentence aloud with expression.

CHALLENGE

Explain how reading with no expression at all changes how a listener understands a passage.

The village was quiet at dawn. A gentle breeze moved through the old wooden bridge, and somewhere in the distance a dog began to bark. Mariam walked slowly along the path, listening to the birds calling from the tall trees. She noticed the market stalls being set up for the day, and the smell of fresh bread drifted from the bakery. By the time the sun rose fully over the hills, the whole village had come alive with voices, laughter, and the steady rhythm of morning work.

Reading	Time	Errors
1st		
2nd		
3rd		

CHALLENGE

Read the passage a fourth time. Did your time improve and your errors decrease?

Deep beneath the ocean's surface, a hidden world thrives in complete darkness. Strange creatures glow with their own light, guiding them through the icy water. Some fish have enormous eyes that capture the smallest traces of light, while others sense vibrations instead of seeing at all. Scientists who study this environment use special submarines to explore places no human has ever reached. Every expedition uncovers new species, reminding us that our planet still holds countless mysteries waiting to be discovered.

Reading	Time	Errors
1st		
2nd		
3rd		

CHALLENGE
Circle the two hardest words to decode in this passage and explain why.

Kwame had never run more than a mile before, but today he stood at the starting line of the district race, determined to finish. His legs felt heavy after the first few minutes, and his breathing grew ragged as the hill ahead seemed to stretch on forever. He remembered his coach's advice: focus on the next step, not the whole distance. Slowly, he found his rhythm again, pushing past the ache in his muscles. When he finally crossed the finish line, exhausted but smiling, he realized that courage was not about feeling strong, it was about continuing anyway.

Reading	Time	Errors
1st		
2nd		
3rd		

CHALLENGE
Explain, in your own words, what the passage's final sentence means about courage.

TEACHING NOTE

Proving a word means using letter sounds AND sentence meaning together to confirm you read it correctly.

WORKED EXAMPLE

"vibrations" → sounds check: vi-bra-tions → meaning check: does the sentence make sense with vibrations?

CLASS EXERCISE

Prove the word 'submarines' from Passage 2 using both sound and meaning.

Prove the word 'exhausted' from Passage 3 using both sound and meaning.

Explain what you do if the sound check and the meaning check disagree.

CHALLENGE

Choose one more unfamiliar word from any passage and prove it fully.

TEACHING NOTE

Proving Practice: apply the proving strategy to a fresh set of words.

WORKED EXAMPLE

"environment" → en-vi-ron-ment → does the sentence make sense with 'environment'? Yes.

CLASS EXERCISE

Prove 'expedition' from Passage 2.

Prove 'determined' from Passage 3.

Prove 'rhythm' from Passage 1.

CHALLENGE

Which of these three words needed the meaning check the most, and why?

TEACHING NOTE

Long-Word Decoding: break long words into syllables before attempting to say them whole.

WORKED EXAMPLE

extraordinary → ex-tra-or-di-nary → blend → check meaning in context.

CLASS EXERCISE

Decode 'submarines' by syllables.

Decode 'vibrations' by syllables.

Decode 'determined' by syllables.

CHALLENGE

Choose the longest word from any passage and show your full syllable breakdown.

TEACHING NOTE

Proofreading Practice: find and correct a spelling error in a sentence drawn from this unit's theme.

CLASS EXERCISE

Correct: 'The submarene explored the deep ocean floor.'

Correct: 'She was completly exhausted after the long race.'

Correct: 'The senctists studied strange glowing fish.'

CHALLENGE

Write all three corrected sentences in full.

TEACHING NOTE

Mixed Decoding: combine syllable division, pattern recognition, and meaning checks in one page.

CLASS EXERCISE

Decode and define 'expedition'.

Decode and define 'environment'.

Decode and define 'rhythm'.

CHALLENGE

Choose the word you found hardest to decode across all three passages, and explain why.

TEACHING NOTE

Independent Fluency: read a passage of your choice from this unit without support, then self-assess.

CLASS EXERCISE

Choose Passage 1, 2, or 3 and read it independently.

Time your reading and count your errors.

Rate your own expression from 1-5 and explain your rating.

CHALLENGE

What is one specific thing you will practice before your next fluency check?

TEACHING NOTE

Fluency Reflection: think back over the whole unit's passages and practice.

CLASS EXERCISE

Which of the three passages (village, ocean, race) did you read most fluently? Why?

Which single word across all three passages took the most practice to read smoothly?

Set one fluency goal for next term.

CHALLENGE

Explain, in your own words, why 'reading fast' alone does not mean 'reading fluently'.

TEACHING NOTE

Unit 6 Test — complete a mixed fluency, decoding and proofreading assessment based on this unit's passages.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Excerpt: "Some fish have enormous eyes that capture the smallest traces of light, while others sense vibrations instead of seeing at all."

CLASS EXERCISE

Read the excerpt aloud with expression, pausing correctly at the comma.

Decode and define 'vibrations' using the sound-and-meaning proving strategy.

Correct this sentence: 'The scyentists used a submarene to explore the ocean floor.'

Explain, in two sentences, the difference between reading accuracy and reading fluency.

CHALLENGE

Choose your own hardest word from any of the three passages studied this unit and prove it fully in writing.

TEACHING NOTE

Whole-Book Revision: before testing, revisit one example from every unit you have studied.

CLASS EXERCISE

Give one example word each for: a short vowel, a vowel team, and an r-controlled vowel (Unit 2).

Give one heteronym pair and mark both stresses (Unit 3).

Give one A-Z pattern word and its pattern (Unit 4).

Give one word from the -ace family and its meaning (Unit 5).

Name one strategy for reading a passage fluently (Unit 6).

CHALLENGE

Which unit's content do you feel least confident about? Make a plan to review it before the test.

TEACHING NOTE

Revision: Pattern and Meaning — connect a spelling pattern to a word's meaning.

CLASS EXERCISE

Explain how -tion changes 'celebrate' into 'celebration'.

Explain the meaning difference between 'desert' (noun) and 'desert' (verb).

Explain what 'populace' means and use it in a sentence.

CHALLENGE

Choose one word from any unit and explain both its pattern and its meaning.

TEACHING NOTE

Revision: Decode and Proofread — apply both decoding and proofreading skills together.

CLASS EXERCISE

Decode 'extraordinary' by syllables.

Correct: 'The submarine explored the ocean floor.'

Correct: 'Her confidence grew after the performance.'

CHALLENGE

Explain the two-step process (decode, then proofread) you used above.

Instructions: Complete independently. This test covers Unit 2's vowel and consonant patterns using Grade 5 words.

Sort into short vowel / long vowel: contrast, migrate, dentist, complete. _____

Divide into syllables: magnificent, government. _____

Circle the consonant blend or digraph: transport, cushion. _____

Mark hard or soft: decide (c), garage (g). _____

Use one Grade 5 word from Unit 2 correctly in a sentence. _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK

Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE

contrast=short a, migrate=long a; magnificent=mag-nif-i-cent, government=gov-ern-ment; transport=blend 'tr', cushion=digraph 'sh'; decide=soft c, garage=soft g (2nd g) / hard g (1st g).

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

Instructions: Complete independently. This test covers Unit 3's syllables, stress, and heteronyms.

- Mark the syllables and stress for 'object' used as a noun. _____
- Mark the syllables and stress for 'object' used as a verb. _____
- Choose one more heteronym and show both pronunciations and meanings. _____
- Divide 'temperature' into syllables and mark its stress. _____
- Use one Unit 3 word correctly in a sentence. _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK
Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE
object (noun) = OB-ject; object (verb) = ob-JECT; temperature = tem-per-a-ture, stress on first syllable.

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

Instructions: Complete independently. This test samples five patterns from across Unit 4's A-Z study.

- Identify the pattern and correct the spelling: 'cotage' (should end in -age). _____
- Identify the pattern and correct the spelling: 'naton' (should contain -tion). _____
- Identify the pattern and correct the spelling: 'imposible' (should contain -ible). _____
- Identify the pattern and correct the spelling: 'realise' or 'realize' — explain both are acceptable -ize/-ise spellings. _____
- Write one original sentence using any -tch word from Unit 4. _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK

Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE

cotage → cottage (-age); naton → nation (-tion); imposible → impossible (-ible); realise/realize both correct depending on British/American spelling.

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

Instructions: Complete independently. This test covers Unit 5's -ace word family in depth.

- Define 'menace' and 'solace' in your own words. _____
- Write an original sentence using 'embrace'. _____
- Spell these four words from dictation: necklace, palace, terrace, furnace. _____
- Map the syllables of 'populace'. _____
- Explain the difference between the schwa -ace sound and the long-a -ace sound, with one example of each. _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK

Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE

menace = a threat; solace = comfort; populace = pop-u-lace (3 syllables); schwa -ace example: palace; long-a -ace example: face.

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

Instructions: Complete independently. This test uses the three original passages studied in Unit 6.

Read aloud: 'Some fish have enormous eyes that capture the smallest traces of light.' Rate your own expression 1-5. _____

Decode and define 'vibrations' using the sound-and-meaning proving strategy. _____

Correct: 'The scyentists used a submarene to explore the ocean floor.' _____

Explain the difference between reading accuracy and reading fluency. _____

Choose your hardest word from any of the three passages and prove it fully in writing. _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK

Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE

vibrations = vi-BRA-tions, meaning: rapid back-and-forth movements; corrected sentence: 'The scientists used a submarine to explore the ocean floor.'

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

Instructions: Complete independently. This final test draws one item from each unit of the whole workbook.

(Unit 2) Divide into syllables and mark the vowel pattern: magnificent. _____

(Unit 3) Mark stress for 'record' as a noun and as a verb. _____

(Unit 4) Identify the pattern and correct: 'imposible'. _____

(Unit 5) Define 'populace' and use it in a sentence. _____

(Unit 6) Correct: 'The submarene explored the deep ocean floor.' _____

Reflect: which unit's skills do you use most often in your own reading outside class? _____

READING / PROOFREADING TASK

Read a short passage from this workbook. Circle one difficult word, prove it, then check its meaning.

TEACHER ANSWER-KEY REFERENCE

magnificent = mag-NIF-i-cent; record (noun) = REC-ord, record (verb) = re-CORD; imposible → impossible; populace = the people of a place; submarene → submarine.

Section	Score
Identification	___ / 5
Application	___ / 5
Explanation	___ / 5
Proofreading	___ / 5
Total	___ / 20

